

MERIDIAN & ASSOCIATES LLP

Advisory | Assurance | Tax | Consulting

Proposal for ERP Implementation Advisory Services

Statewide Health System - RFP #IT-2025-118

CLIENT CONFIDENTIAL - BLINDED

Version 1.0 | Effective Date: July 2025

Meridian & Associates LLP | New York | Chicago | San Francisco | London | Singapore

This document is the proprietary and confidential property of Meridian & Associates LLP. It is intended solely for the use of the designated recipient(s). Any unauthorized reproduction, distribution, or disclosure of this material is strictly prohibited.

Cover Letter

July 15, 2025

Mr. Robert Patel, Chief Information Officer
Statewide Health System
1200 Medical Center Drive, Suite 400
Columbus, OH 43210

Dear Mr. Patel,

Meridian & Associates LLP is pleased to present our proposal in response to RFP #IT-2025-118 for Enterprise Resource Planning (ERP) Implementation Advisory Services. We understand that Statewide Health System is embarking on a comprehensive ERP modernization initiative to replace aging financial, supply chain, and human capital management systems across your 12-hospital network and 85 ambulatory care facilities.

This is precisely the type of complex, mission-critical transformation where Meridian excels. Our Healthcare Technology Advisory practice has guided 28 health systems through ERP implementations over the past decade, representing a combined program value exceeding \$1.4 billion. We bring deep expertise in the unique challenges of healthcare ERP -- from clinical-financial integration to regulatory compliance, from supply chain optimization to workforce management.

Our proposed engagement lead, Michael Torres, CPA, PMP, has personally overseen 9 healthcare ERP implementations and brings 24 years of healthcare advisory experience. He will be supported by a multidisciplinary team of ERP specialists, change management consultants, and healthcare operations experts.

We look forward to the opportunity to serve as Statewide Health System's trusted advisor on this transformative initiative.

Sincerely,

Michael Torres, CPA, PMP
Lead Partner, Healthcare & Life Sciences Practice
Meridian & Associates LLP
Phone: (312) 555-0287
Email: m.torres@meridian-llp.com

1. Executive Summary

Statewide Health System's current IT landscape includes a patchwork of legacy systems -- a 15-year-old financial management system (Lawson), separate supply chain platforms for acute and ambulatory settings, multiple time-and-attendance systems, and over 200 custom integrations. This fragmentation creates significant operational inefficiencies, limits real-time visibility, and increases compliance risk.

Meridian proposes to serve as the independent ERP Advisory Partner, providing end-to-end program oversight from vendor selection through go-live and stabilization. Our role is distinct from and independent of the ERP implementation vendor, ensuring Statewide Health System has an objective advocate focused solely on your interests throughout the program.

Scope of Advisory Services

- ERP Vendor Evaluation and Selection: Structured evaluation of shortlisted vendors (Oracle Health, Workday, Infor) using weighted scoring methodology
- Program Governance and PMO: Establish governance framework, program management office, and executive reporting cadence
- Business Process Redesign: Facilitate redesign of 140+ business processes across Finance, Supply Chain, HR, and Payroll
- Data Migration Strategy: Develop comprehensive data migration plan, including data cleansing, mapping, validation, and cutover
- Integration Architecture: Design and oversee integration strategy for 45+ interfacing systems (Epic EHR, Kronos, Workday Adaptive, etc.)
- Change Management and Training: Enterprise-wide change management program covering 18,000 end users across 97 locations
- Risk Management: Continuous risk monitoring, issue escalation, and mitigation planning
- Quality Assurance and Testing: Independent testing oversight including UAT, integration testing, performance testing, and parallel processing
- Go-Live Support and Stabilization: On-site support during cutover weekends and 90-day post-go-live stabilization period

2. Methodology and Approach

Phase 1: Discovery and Vendor Selection (Months 1-4)

Our discovery phase begins with a comprehensive assessment of Statewide Health System's current state, including detailed process documentation, pain point analysis, and requirements gathering across all functional areas. We conduct stakeholder interviews with 80+ department leaders and super-users to understand both stated and latent requirements.

For vendor selection, we employ Meridian's proprietary Healthcare ERP Evaluation Framework, which evaluates vendors across 12 dimensions including functional fit, technical architecture, healthcare regulatory compliance, total cost of ownership, implementation risk, and vendor financial stability. We facilitate structured vendor demonstrations using scenario-based scripts tailored to Statewide's operations, and conduct reference checks with comparable health systems.

Phase 2: Program Planning and Design (Months 5-8)

Once a vendor is selected, we establish the program governance structure, detailed project plans, and begin the business process redesign effort. Our approach to process redesign follows the 'adopt, adapt, enhance' philosophy -- leveraging ERP best practices wherever possible, adapting to Statewide-specific requirements only where clinically or operationally necessary, and enhancing processes through automation and workflow optimization.

- Establish Program Steering Committee with executive sponsorship from CFO, CIO, CHRO, and CMO
- Create detailed work breakdown structure with 1,200+ activities across 18 workstreams
- Facilitate 40+ business process redesign workshops across Finance, Supply Chain, HR/Payroll
- Develop data migration strategy covering 8 source systems and 15+ years of historical data
- Design integration architecture for bidirectional interfaces with Epic (ADT, charges, clinical documentation)

Phase 3: Build and Configure (Months 9-16)

During the build phase, Meridian provides independent quality assurance oversight of the implementation vendor's configuration, development, and testing activities. We conduct weekly technical reviews, monitor milestone completion, and escalate risks to the Steering Committee.

- Weekly QA reviews of configuration decisions against approved business process designs
- Independent code review of custom extensions, reports, and interfaces
- Monthly program health assessments using Meridian's ERP Program Risk Index (PRI)
- Bi-weekly executive status reports with red/amber/green dashboard
- Change management activities: stakeholder engagement, communications, role-based training curriculum design

Phase 4: Testing and Validation (Months 17-20)

Meridian designs and oversees the comprehensive testing strategy, including system integration testing (SIT), user acceptance testing (UAT), performance testing, security testing, and parallel processing. We provide independent test result validation and defect triage support.

Phase 5: Go-Live and Stabilization (Months 21-24)

Our go-live approach employs a phased rollout strategy -- beginning with the corporate office and two pilot hospitals before expanding to the full 12-hospital network. This approach reduces risk while allowing the team to incorporate lessons learned from each deployment wave.

3. Team Qualifications

Engagement Lead: Michael Torres, CPA, PMP

Experience: 24 years in healthcare advisory, 9 ERP implementations

Relevant Clients: Regional Health Corp (12 hospitals), Pacific Medical Centers (8 hospitals), University Health System

Michael will serve as the engagement partner and primary executive relationship manager. He will participate in all Steering Committee meetings and provide strategic guidance throughout the program.

Program Director: Jennifer Walsh, PMP, CPHIMS

Experience: 18 years in healthcare IT advisory, 6 ERP implementations as program director

Jennifer will serve as the full-time on-site program director, responsible for day-to-day management of Meridian's advisory team and coordination with the implementation vendor. She recently completed a 22-month Oracle Health Financials implementation at a 9-hospital system in the Southeast.

Supply Chain Lead: Marcus Chen, CSCP

Experience: 14 years in healthcare supply chain optimization

Marcus specializes in healthcare supply chain transformation, including item master optimization, par level management, and clinical preference item standardization. He will lead the supply chain workstream and integration with clinical systems.

Change Management Lead: Dr. Amanda Foster, PROSCI

Experience: 16 years in organizational change management, 11 in healthcare

Amanda holds a doctorate in Organizational Psychology and is a certified PROSCI change management practitioner. She has led change management for 5 healthcare ERP programs, developing training programs for organizations with up to 25,000 end users.

4. Relevant Experience

Regional Health Corporation (12 Hospitals, 22,000 Employees)

Engagement: ERP Advisory Services for Oracle Cloud Financials and SCM Implementation

Duration: 26 months (completed March 2025)

Program Budget: [REDACTED]

Meridian served as the independent advisory partner for Regional Health's enterprise-wide Oracle Cloud implementation. The program encompassed General Ledger, Accounts Payable, Procurement, Inventory Management, and Fixed Assets across all 12 hospitals and 45 ambulatory locations. Key outcomes include: on-time go-live for all three deployment waves, 99.7% data migration accuracy, 22% reduction in purchase order cycle time, and \$8.5M in identified cost savings through supply chain standardization.

Pacific Medical Centers (8 Hospitals, 15,000 Employees)

Engagement: Workday HCM/Payroll Implementation Advisory

Duration: 18 months (completed November 2024)

Program Budget: [REDACTED]

Advised Pacific Medical Centers on the implementation of Workday HCM and Payroll, replacing three legacy HR systems and two payroll platforms. Meridian provided program governance, change management, and integration oversight for the complex interface between Workday and Kronos Workforce Dimensions (scheduling and timekeeping). The program achieved first-payroll accuracy of 99.94% and reduced payroll processing time by 40%.

University Health System (Academic Medical Center, 8,500 Employees)

Engagement: ERP Vendor Selection and Contract Negotiation

Duration: 6 months (completed June 2025)

Negotiated Savings: [REDACTED]

Meridian led a structured vendor evaluation process comparing Oracle Health, Workday, and Infor CloudSuite Healthcare. Our evaluation framework, scenario-based demonstrations, and reference checks enabled University Health to make a confident selection decision. During contract negotiation, Meridian's deep knowledge of healthcare ERP pricing models resulted in significant reductions from the vendor's initial proposal, along with enhanced service-level agreements and contractual protections.

5. Investment Summary

Meridian's advisory fees are structured on a fixed-fee basis by program phase, providing Statewide Health System with cost certainty and transparency. All fees include travel, technology, and administrative expenses.

Fee by Phase

Phase 1: Discovery and Vendor Selection (4 months): [REDACTED]

Phase 2: Program Planning and Design (4 months): [REDACTED]

Phase 3: Build and Configure (8 months): [REDACTED]

Phase 4: Testing and Validation (4 months): [REDACTED]

Phase 5: Go-Live and Stabilization (4 months): [REDACTED]

Total Advisory Fee (24 months): [REDACTED]

Staffing Summary

- Engagement Partner: 20% allocation throughout program
- Program Director: 100% on-site allocation throughout program
- Functional Leads (3): 80% allocation during their active phases
- Change Management Lead: 60% allocation Phases 2-5, 100% during go-live
- Staff Consultants (4-6): Variable allocation based on phase requirements

Note: Staffing levels may be adjusted by mutual agreement based on program needs. Any material changes to staffing will be communicated and approved through the governance process.